

Global Superstore – Customer Support Escalation Policy

Escalation Triggers

An order or customer inquiry is escalated beyond Tier 1 support when any of the following occur:

- A return or refund request is disputed by the customer after initial resolution.
- An order's Order Priority is Critical and the response SLA (see Customer Segment Service Policy) is missed.
- A discount request exceeds the auto-approval tiers defined in the Discount and Pricing Policy.
- A shipment is delayed beyond the thresholds defined in the Shipping and Delivery Policy.
- A Corporate account's cumulative negative-Profit orders exceed 3 in a rolling 90-day period.

Escalation Tiers

1. **Tier 1 Support:** Handles standard inquiries — order status, standard returns, general shipping

questions. Resolution target: same interaction where possible.

2. **Tier 2 Specialist:** Handles disputed returns, non-standard discount requests, and multi-shipment order issues. Resolution target: 1 business day.
3. **Regional Customer Experience Lead:** Handles Consumer and Home Office segment escalations that Tier 2 cannot resolve, including policy exceptions.
4. **Regional Sales Director:** Handles Corporate segment escalations involving contract terms, net-30 invoicing disputes, or account-level pricing.
5. **Business Operations Team:** Final escalation point for discount approvals above 50%, segment reclassification requests, and cross-market policy conflicts.

Response Time Standards

Response SLAs vary by segment and Order Priority as defined in the Customer Segment Service Policy; escalations do not reset the SLA clock — they inherit the original inquiry's timestamp.

Documentation Requirements

Every escalation must be logged with: Order ID, Customer ID, Product ID (if applicable), the specific

policy section being invoked, and the requested resolution. Escalations without a referenced Order ID are returned to Tier 1 for verification before proceeding.

Refund and Compensation Authority by Tier

- Tier 1 and Tier 2: May authorize standard refunds and shipping cost adjustments as defined in existing policy.
- Regional Customer Experience Lead: May authorize policy exceptions up to \$200 in order value.
- Regional Sales Director: May authorize policy exceptions up to \$2,000 in order value for Corporate accounts.
- Business Operations Team: Unlimited authorization, subject to finance sign-off for amounts above \$2,000.